

General Election 2026: Denmark Is Dividing... As Usual

(This is the English version of the original LinkedIn-post. Illustrations are in the rep as well.)

The gap between rural and urban Denmark has widened following the general election, as documented by Nikolaj Gjøde and others.

The real news, however, is that this has been happening for quite some time. The **Index of Geographic Skewness (IGS)** in party voter support has risen steadily from **16% in 2011 to 21% in 2026** (see the table in the comments).

Reasons

There may be several explanations for this. One is the increasing focus on party leaders (or other prominent candidates), as Kasper Møller Hansen has pointed out. This tends to boost vote totals in their own constituencies. Another explanation may lie in the issues that dominated the election campaign, which Johan Irving Søltoft and Anders Kristian Munk have explored using machine learning methods.

The fact remains that geographic inequality is increasing—but not as dramatically as one might think. While some parties contribute to greater geographic polarization, others are experiencing a more even geographic distribution of voter support.

Most skewed

The **Denmark Democrats** are by far the most geographically polarized party. In the five constituencies where the party enjoys its strongest support, it received **30,000 votes**. The party received the same total number of votes across the **38 constituencies** where its support was weakest.

The Denmark Democrats' electorate is distributed more unevenly across the country than that of any other party, with an **IGS of 45%**. (The index is defined as the area between the party's Lorenz curve and the dashed diagonal. An IGI of **0%** means that votes are distributed evenly across all constituencies, while **100%** would mean that every vote for the party was cast in a single constituency.)

Least skewed

The **Liberal Alliance** has the most geographically even distribution of voter support, with an **IGS of just 10%**, illustrated by the curve closest to the dashed line representing perfect equality. In the five constituencies where the party received the most support, it won just over **29,000 votes**—roughly the same number it received across the **14 constituencies** where its support was weakest.

The remaining parties fall somewhere between these two extremes in terms of geographic inequality.

Trends

The development over the last five general elections reflects two opposing trends (see the table in the comments).

Some parties have seen their IGS increase. This is particularly true for the **Red-Green Alliance (Enhedslisten)**, the **Social Liberal Party (Radikale Venstre)**, the **Danish People's Party (Dansk Folkeparti)**, and—following the 2026 election—also **Venstre**, whose IGS has risen from just **14% in 2011** to **27% in 2026**.

At the same time, other parties have become more geographically balanced. This applies, for example, to the **Liberal Alliance** and, over the last three general elections, also to the **Socialist People's Party (SF)**. In addition, some of the most geographically concentrated parties disappear from one election to the next.

Reflections

What are the implications?

Could this become a convenient explanation if coalition negotiations drag on?

Could prolonged government formation have knock-on effects for municipal budget planning, as Local Government Denmark has suggested?

And will this trend continue in the years ahead?

Time will tell.

My curiosity about this topic, combined with my background as a data science student, inspired this analysis. An update will follow after the next general election.